

Fig. Epilogue 1: Depiction of Ashoka supported by his wives on the upper segment of gateway pillar at Sanchi

Other emblems associated with the emperor also figure. Wheel-bearing pillars, monoliths crowned with capitals of four lions, the vajrasana at Mahabodhi—all clearly recognizable as Ashokan—were constantly and conspicuously carved into the gateways of Sanchi. Several pillars of Shunga and Gupta times also imitated the Ashokan monoliths. The Shunga period pillar at Sanchi, with its capital of lotus leaves, and the four lions capital of